Group: Lakshika · Kinshuk
Prashant · Inaya

रास्ता

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Part. 01

Research Methodologies.

We used a mixed-method approach that combined interviews, surveys, and user walkthroughs to address this challenge and develop a more comprehensive understanding of user needs and behaviors.



Some methods we used :

Site observation

Walkthrough

Spatial mapping

Interviews & Survey

Thematic analysis

Part. 01

Interviews

User 01 · Frequent Visitor

Possible observation: Familiarity helps the user navigate, but may not eliminate the whole acknowledgment of all the locations

Sample response, not an actual quote

> “I generally know where I need to go, but I still have to rely on memory. When I need to find an unfamiliar location, I may have to ask someone.”

Potential insight: Regular visitors may navigate through learned routes rather than clear visual guidance.

Problem to investigate: Missing signage could make unfamiliar destinations difficult to locate, even for frequent visitors.

User 02 · First-Time Visitor

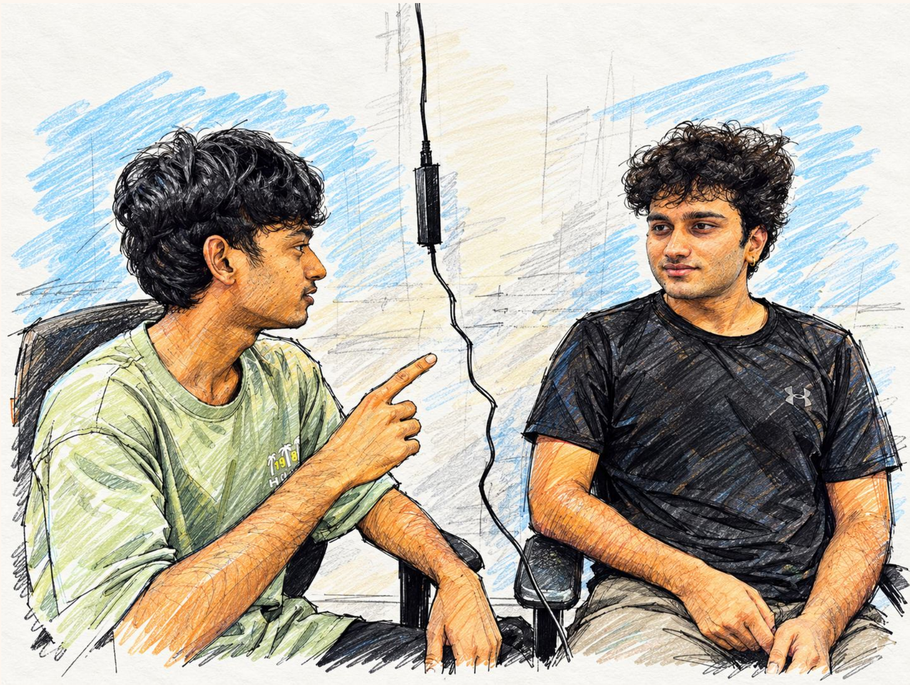
Possible observation: The user needs information about destinations and directions from the moment they enter the floor.

Sample response, not an actual quote

> “I am not sure which direction to take. Without signs, I would need to ask someone where the room or exit is.”

Potential insight: First-time visitors depend more on visible, understandable information because they lack prior spatial knowledge.

Problem to investigate: Visitors may struggle to locate destinations independently when directional information is unavailable..



User 03 · Occasional Visitor

Possible observation: Previous visits provide familiarity with basic structure, but finding specific location may be difficult.

Sample response, not an actual quote

> “I have been here before, but I do not remember exactly where everything is. I might need to look around or ask for directions.”

Potential insight: Occasional visitors may experience uncertainty even after visiting the floor previously.

Problem to investigate: The environment may not provide enough persistent visual cues to help visitors recognize routes and destinations.

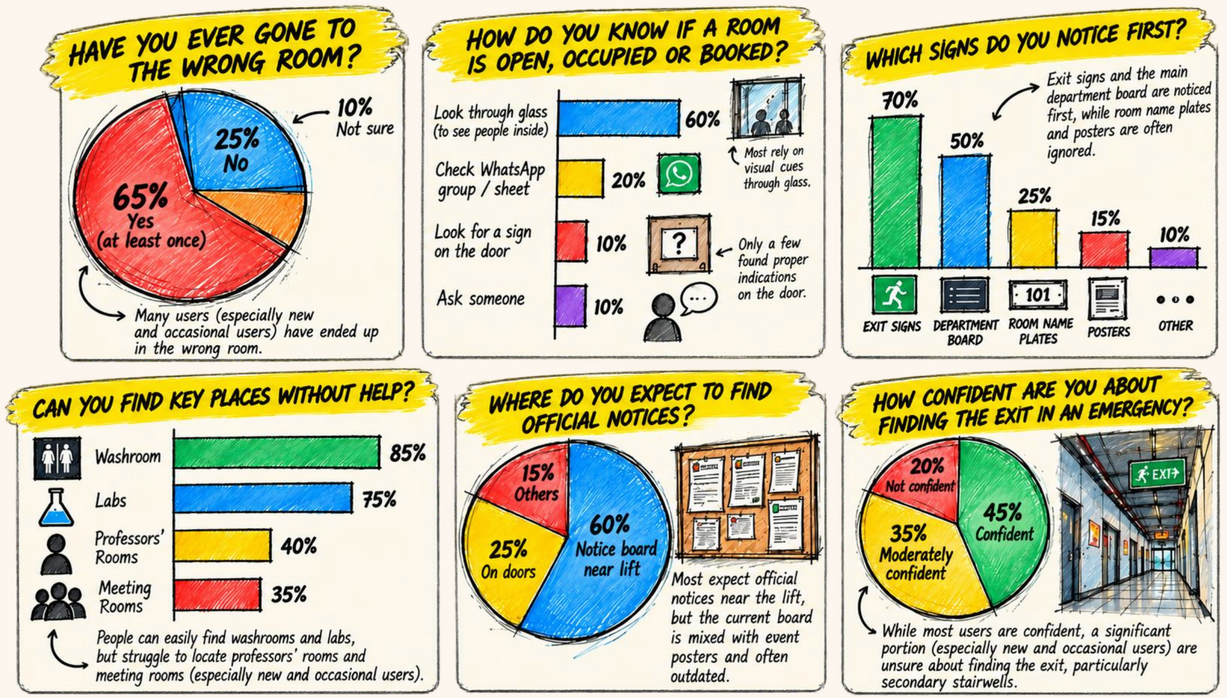
Part. 01

Surveys

Our surveys revealed significant gaps in wayfinding, room identification, and accessibility on the 4th floor of the R&D Building.

01 — Navigation Confusion
65% of respondents reported having entered the wrong room at least once.

02 — Unclear Room Occupancy
60% rely on looking through glass or checking WhatsApp groups to determine whether a room is occupied.



03 — Missing Directional Cues
Exit signs and the main department board were the most noticed signs, while other wayfinding cues received less attention.

04 — Difficulty Locating Facilities
Although washrooms and labs were relatively easy to locate, professors' rooms and meeting rooms were harder to find.

05 — Inadequate Emergency Information
60% expected official notices near the lift, while 35% reported only moderate confidence in finding an exit during an emergency.

These findings highlight the need for a more intuitive, informative, and inclusive wayfinding system.

Part. 02

Problems We Identified



01
Missing Emergency Exit Plan

No clearly visible exit plan was displayed at the entrance, making emergency navigation difficult. Our survey revealed that **70% of respondents had difficulty locating the exit plan.**



02
Lack of Floor Plan and Wing Identification

The absence of a floor map and directional wing signage made it difficult for users to locate rooms. Even when users knew a lab number, such as A102 or B102, they struggled to determine which wing and direction to follow.

03
Unclear Room Occupancy

Users had no way to determine whether a room was occupied or available from the lobby. They had to walk to the room to check its status and return if it was unavailable, resulting in unnecessary movement and wasted time.

Part. 02

Problems We Identified





04
Inadequate Directional Signage

There were no clear directional signs guiding users towards essential facilities such as staircases, washrooms, and drinking water. Interviews with newcomers revealed that they could identify only one staircase near the entrance, overlooking the other two.

05
Inaccessible Signage for Persons with Disabilities (PwD)

The fire exit plan and information boards were positioned approximately **1,680 mm above the floor**, potentially making them difficult to read for wheelchair users and people with limited reach. But as per ACCESSIBILITY STANDARDS AND GUIDELINES FOR CIVIL AVIATION - good vision height for pwd is 1300mm

06
Lack of Tactile Guidance for Visually Impaired Users

The absence of a tactile guidance system made independent navigation difficult for people with visual impairments, particularly when identifying rooms and moving through corridors.

Part. 03

Iterating Problem Statement

01 Iteration

Identifying the problem
The 4th floor of the R&D Building has inadequate signage, making it difficult for users to locate rooms, staircases, washrooms, and other essential facilities.

02 Iteration

Understanding user difficulties
The lack of clear directional signage, floor plans, and wing identification forces users, particularly newcomers, to rely on guesswork and seek assistance to navigate the floor.

03 Iteration

Expanding the scope
Beyond wayfinding, the absence of room occupancy information and insufficient accessibility cues creates unnecessary movement and makes independent navigation challenging for users with diverse needs.

04 Iteration

Integrating the findings
The 4th floor lacks a unified wayfinding and communication system that connects spatial identification, directional guidance, room availability, emergency information, and inclusive navigation.

↑Iterations=Better

Part. 03

Final Problem Statement

The 4th floor of the R&D Building lacks a cohesive, intuitive, and inclusive wayfinding and communication system. Inadequate directional signage, unclear spatial identification, unavailable room occupancy information, and insufficient accessibility cues create navigation barriers, forcing users to rely on guesswork or additional effort to locate destinations and facilities independently.

01
Signage
Missing directions

02
Spatial
Unclear wings

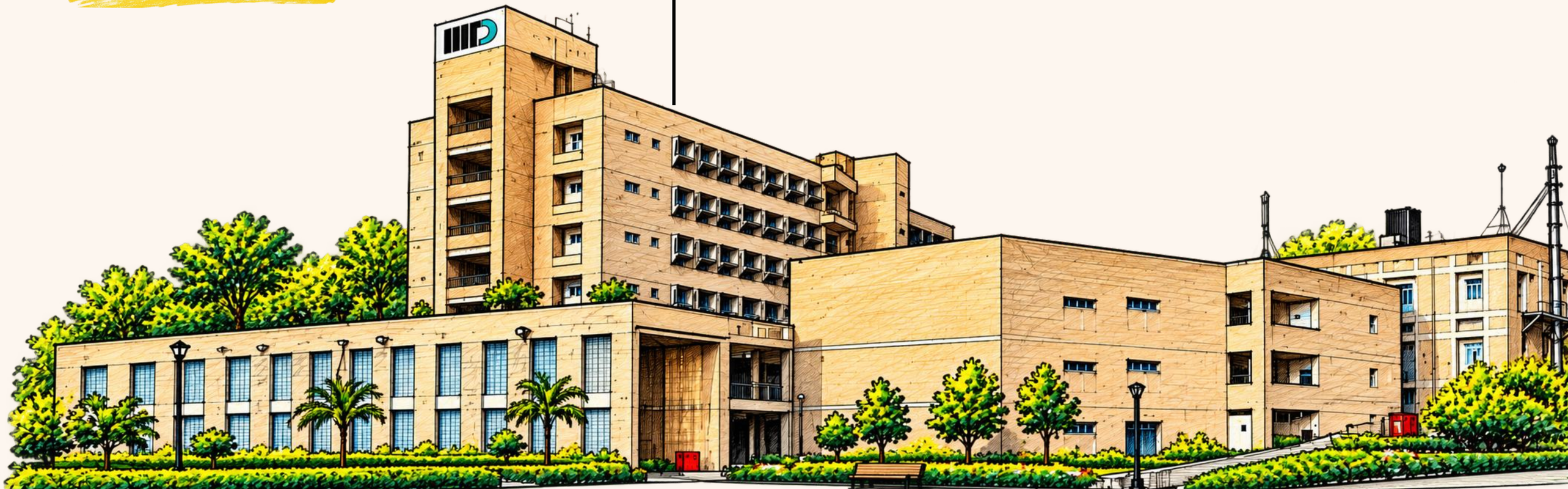
03
Occupancy
Unknown availability

04
Inclusion
Access barriers

Part. 04

Solving the Problems

A unified wayfinding system for the 4th floor of the R&D Building — making navigation clearer, room information accessible, and movement more intuitive for everyone.



Part. 04

Solving the Problems

Color Theme

The department is divided into two wings:
Wing-A - Human Centered Design Department
Wing-B - Center for Artificial Intelligence
We have used both department color identity and applied it to the Sign Boards to let people distinguish between both the departments

Wing-A:

HUMAN CENTERED DESIGN



Wing-B:



Infosys®
CENTRE FOR
ARTIFICIAL
INTELLIGENCE
Finding patterns to change the world for the better...

Part. 04

Solving the Problems

- The Indian *Harmonised Guidelines and Standards for Universal Accessibility* (2021) recommend legible sans-serif typefaces for signage, citing Helvetica Medium as an example.
  Montserrat and Helvetica, both belong to the broader sans-serif category. Montserrat provide us with :

- **Clarity:** Its clean, sans-serif letter forms support clear presentation of room names, directions and facility information.
- **Visual hierarchy:** Different weights and styles establish a distinction between headings, room numbers, directional information and secondary details while maintaining typographic consistency.
- **Institutional identity:** Its modern, structured appearance complements the research-oriented environment of the R&D Building.
- **System-wide consistency:** Using one typeface family across multiple signage formats creates a cohesive visual language and helps users recognise information consistently.
- **Accessibility-oriented design:** Montserrat's sans-serif form aligns with the Indian Harmonised Guidelines' recommendation to use standard, legible sans-serif typefaces for signage.

Font Selection

Montserrat was selected as the primary typeface for the wayfinding system because its geometric sans-serif character creates a clean, contemporary and consistent visual identity across room signs, directional boards and information panels.

AaBa AaBa **A-10**
AaBa AaBa **A-10**
AaBa AaBa **A-10**

Part. 04

Redesigning the first View



In Interview we got to know:
"...the first question i think of is in which direction to go..."

↓

We placed a glassed transparent glowing board at middle of the floor(marked by red dot). inclined at 30-Degrees. Height around 1200 mm.

This number is supported by *Harmonised Guidelines and Standards for Universal Accessibility in India, 2021, Chapter 5, Signage and Information Systems*. Which is in vision of the **pwd** people on WheelChair

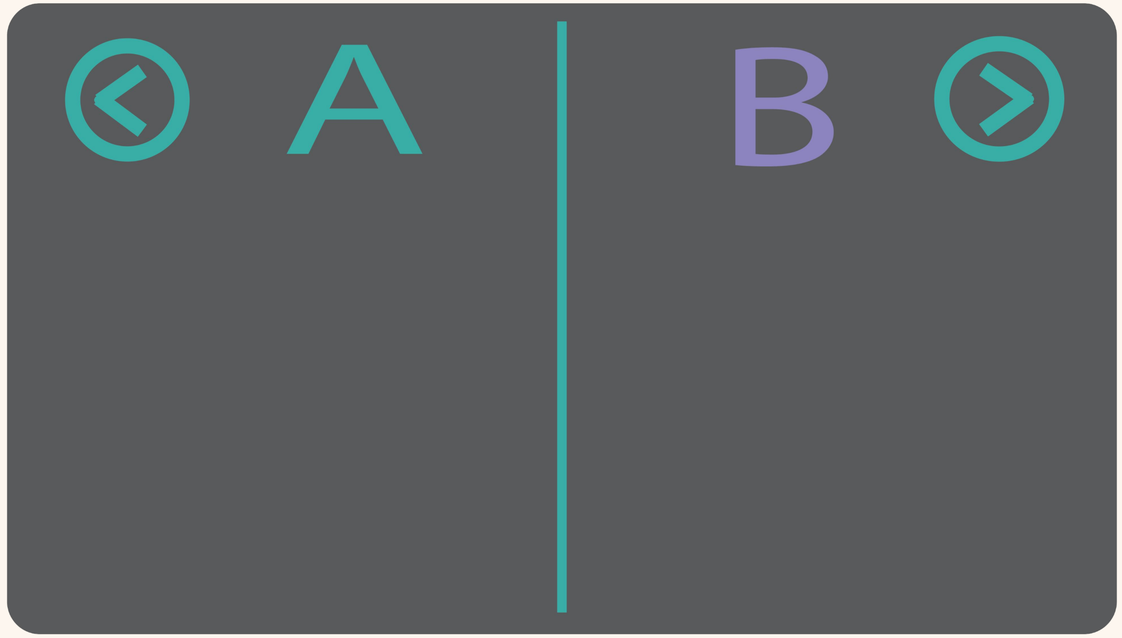
⟶ this is the first view of what one see on entrance

*the iterations of the proposed design are shown on next page

Part. 04

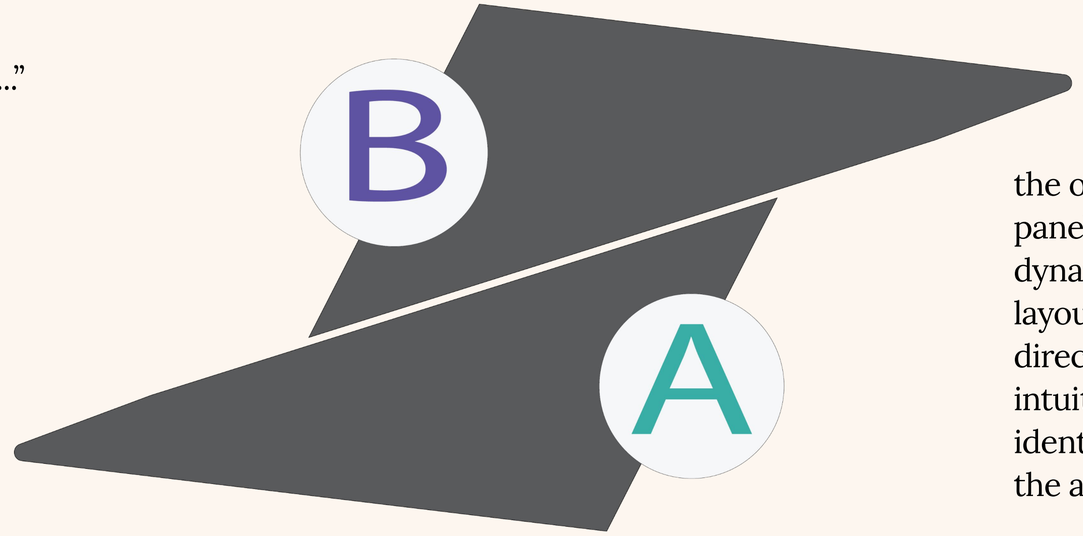
Redesigning the first View

the design lacked directional and thematic clarity, as the arrows were visually separated from the A/B identifiers.



In Interview we got to know:
“...the first question i think of is in which direction to go...”

Some Designs we tested
(all designs are designed by us on illustrator)



the overlapping, diagonal panels created a visually dynamic but confusing layout, making the directional flow less intuitive. The oversized A/B identifiers competed with the arrows,

Part. 04

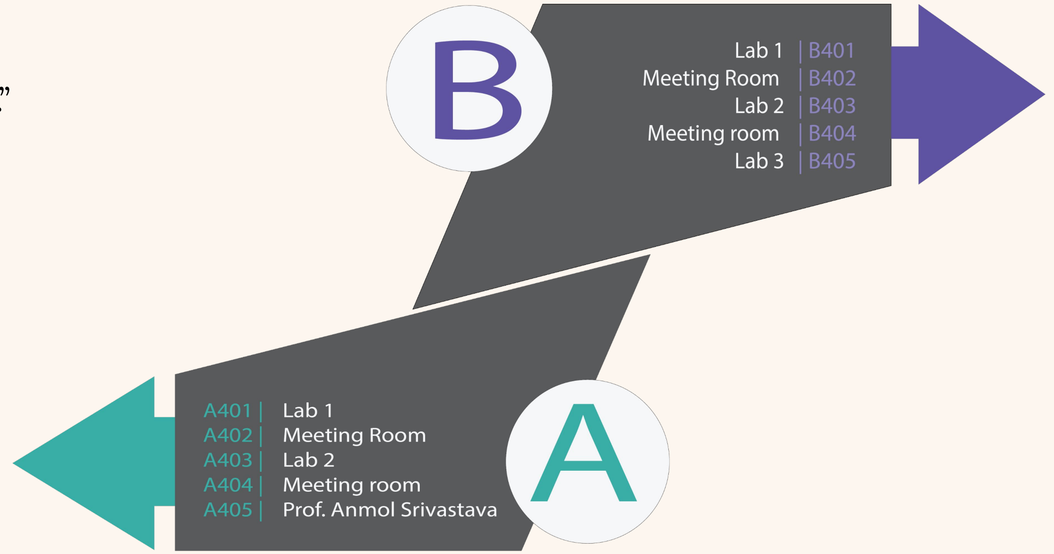
Redesigning the first View

We rejected this iteration because the oversized circular A/B labels overlap the information panels, creating visual clutter and reducing space for clear, structured room information.



In Interview we got to know:
“...the first question i think of is in which direction to go...”

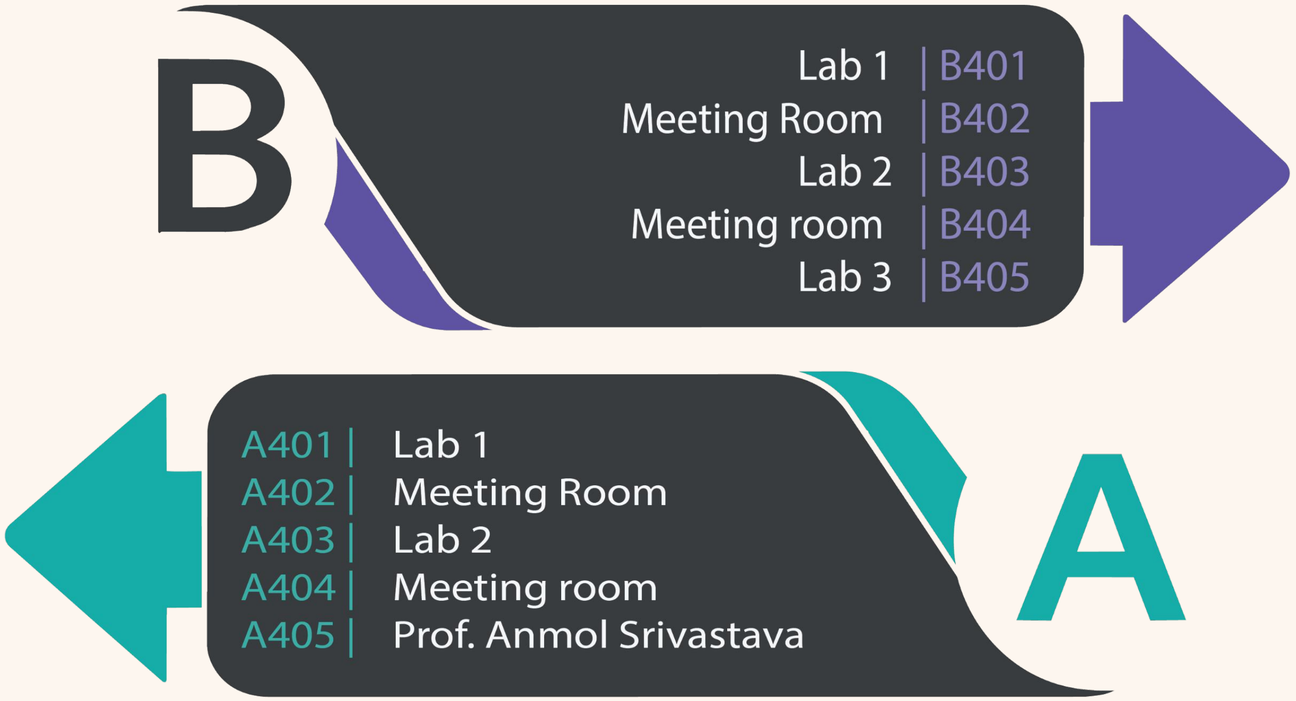
Some Designs we tested
(all designs are designed by us on illustrator)



We rejected this iteration because the diagonal panels and overlapping A/B labels create visual complexity, making the signage less structured and harder to scan quickly.

Part. 04

Redesigning the first View



In Interview we got to know:
"...the first question i think of is in which direction to go..."

Some Designs we tested
(all designs are designed by us on illustrator)

Why We Selected This Design

- **Departmental Colour Coding:** Teal and purple distinguish the CSD and CSAI departments.
- **Clear Directional Guidance:** Prominent arrows make directions to Blocks A and B easy to identify.
- **Quick Identification:** Large A/B labels improve visibility and recognition.
- **Structured Information:** Aligned room names and numbers enable quick scanning.
- **Visual Consistency:** Coordinated colours, typography and compact panels create a clean, cohesive wayfinding system.

Part. 04

Redesigning the signage

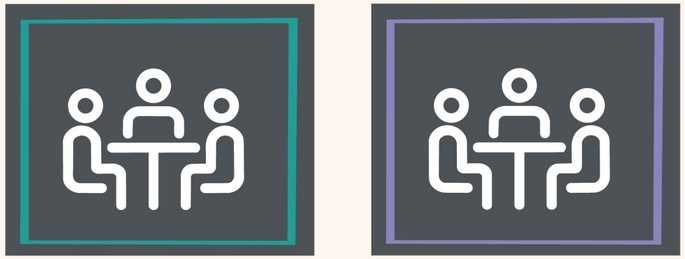






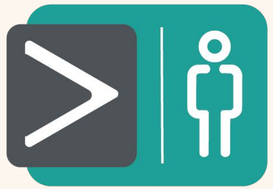


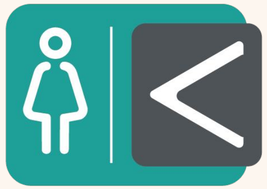




Part. 04

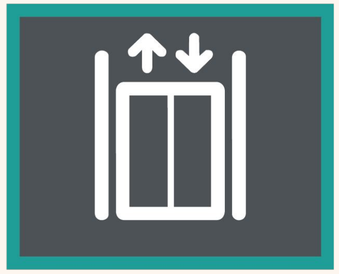
Redesigning the signage

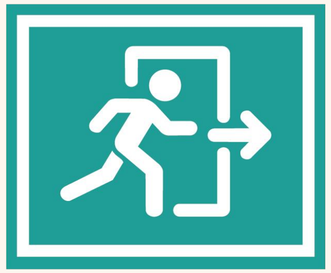












National Building Code of India (NBC) 2016, Part 4: Fire and Life Safety, published by the Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS).
In Section 3.4.7.4 — Exit Signage, it states that exit signs must be illuminated, connected to an alternative power supply, and green in colour.

Wing-A-HCD

Part. 05

Scaling



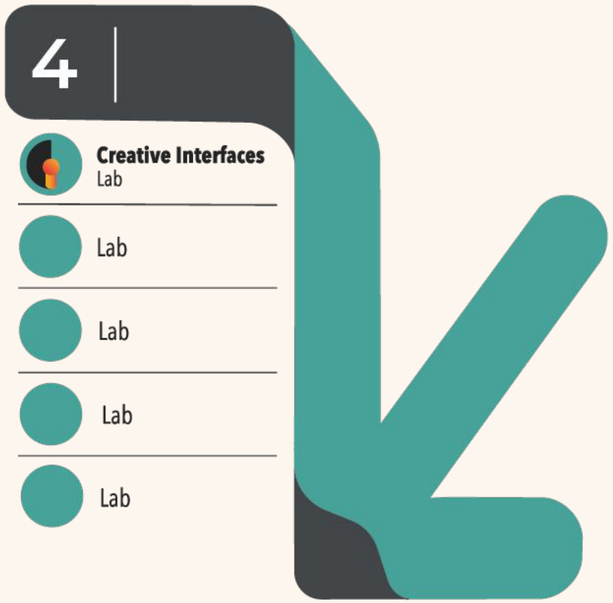
















Wing-B-ICAI

Part. 05

Scaling



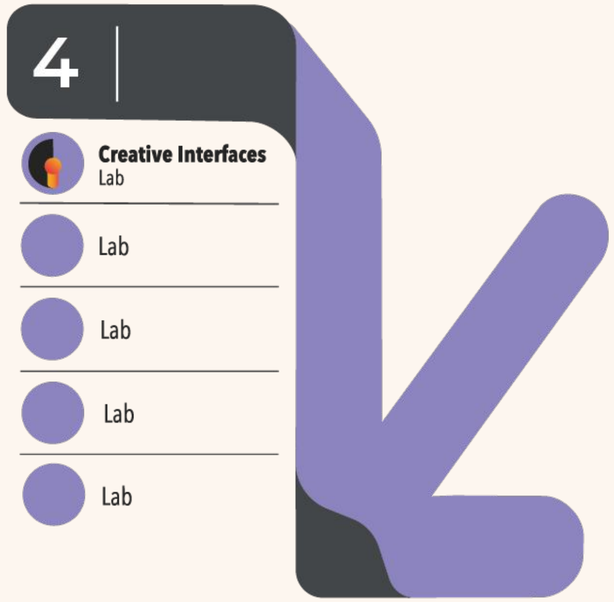


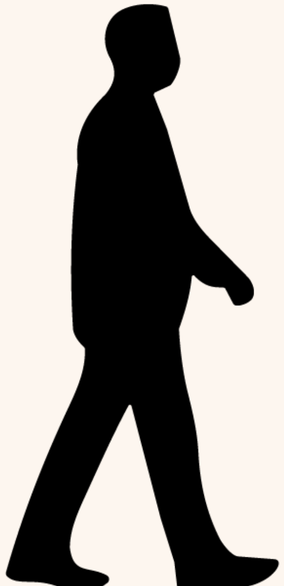








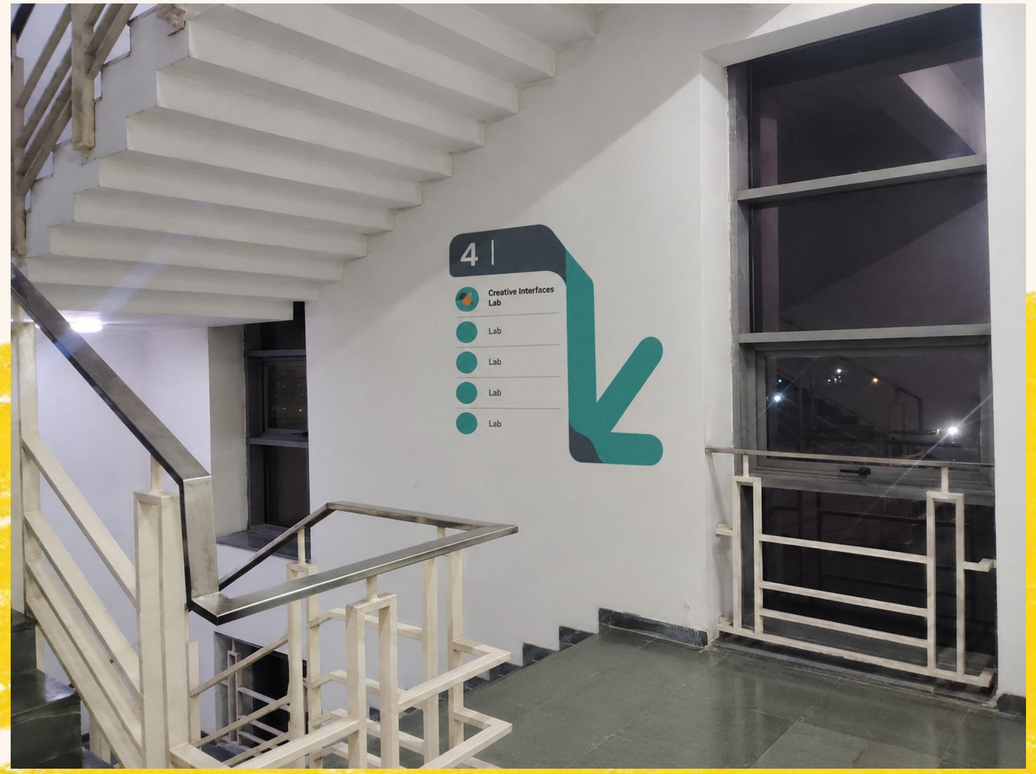


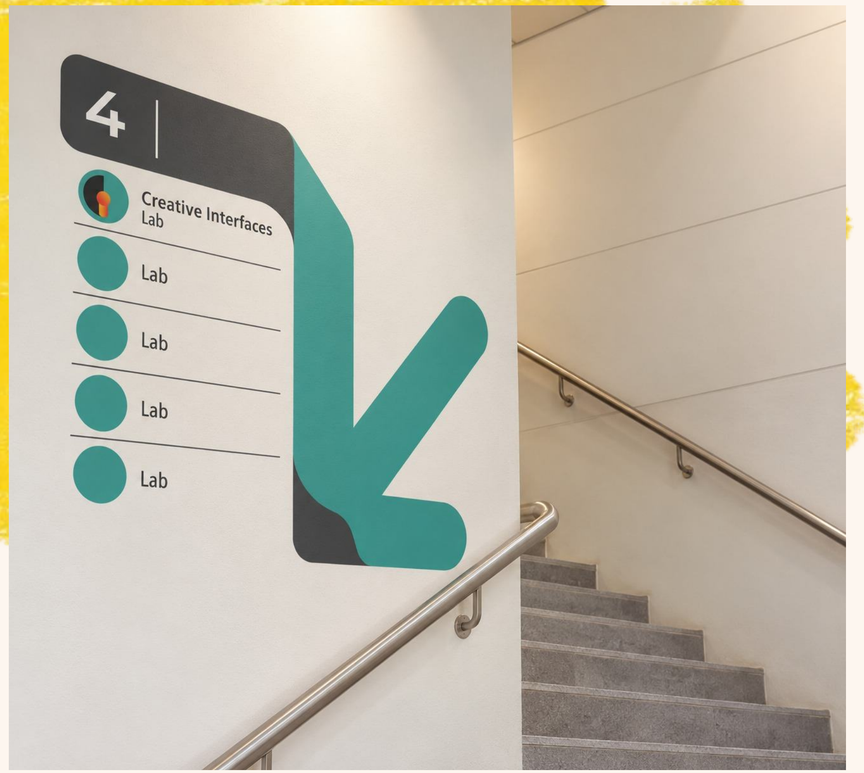




Part. 06

Prototype





Part. 06

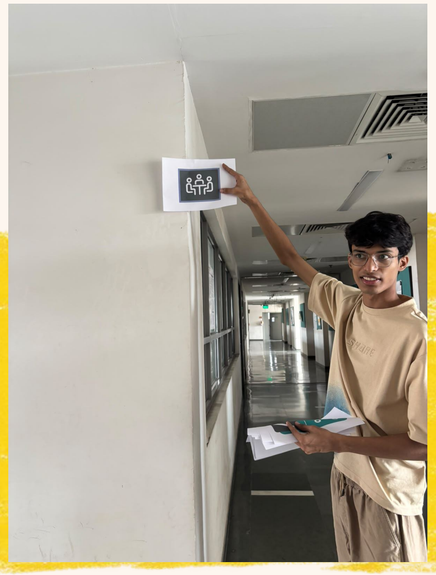
Prototype

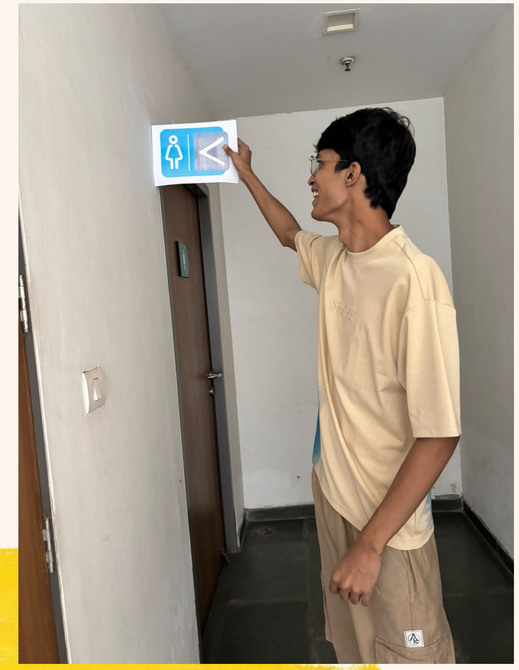


Part. 06

Prototype













Part. 07

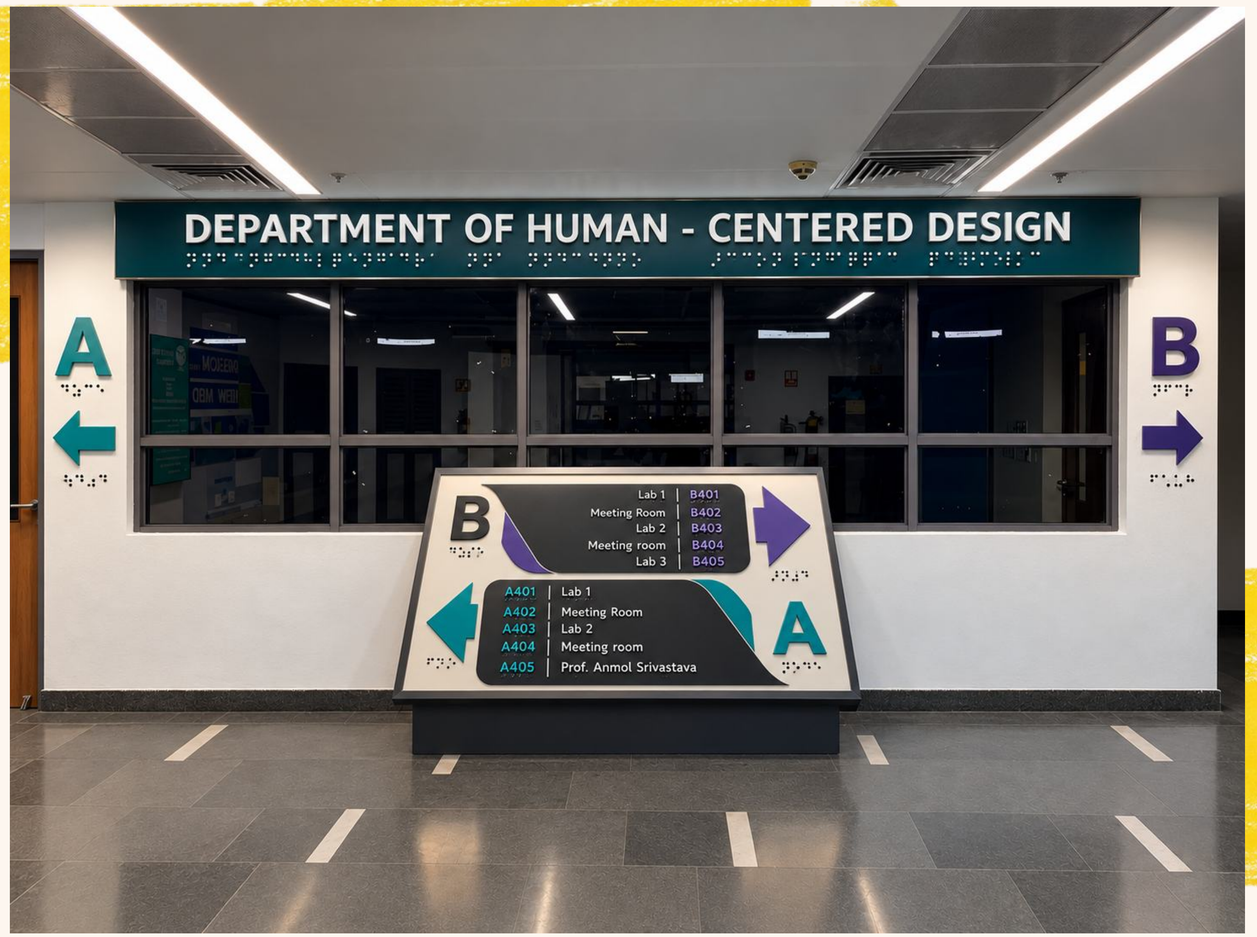
Braille for pwd



The primary reference is the Government of India's Harmonised Guidelines and Standards for Universal Accessibility in India, 2021, prepared by the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA). It includes Chapter 5, Signage and Information Systems.

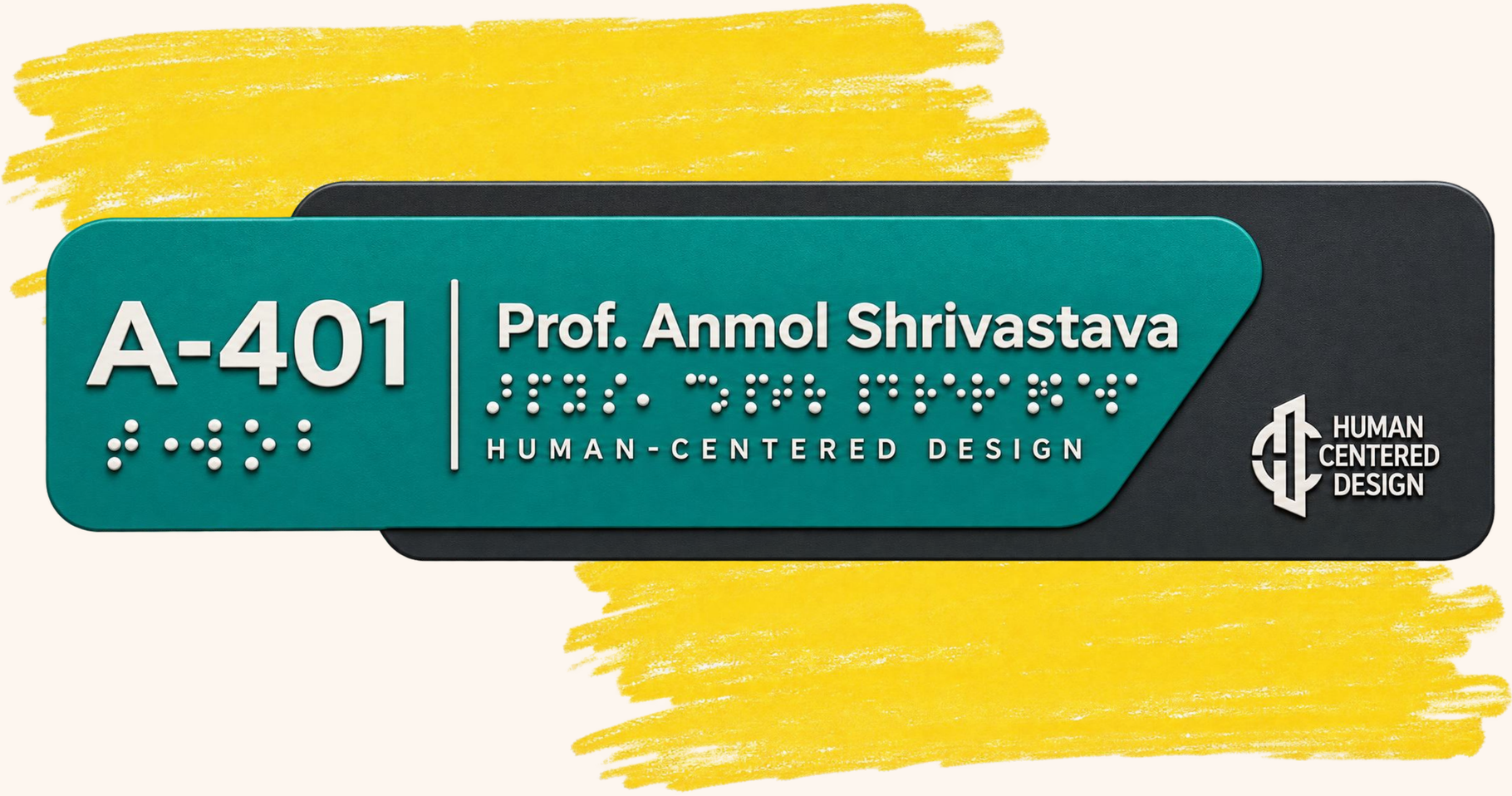
Part. 07

Braille for pwd



Part. 07

Braille for pwd



The primary reference is the Government of India's Harmonised Guidelines and Standards for Universal Accessibility in India, 2021, prepared by the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA). It includes Chapter 5, Signage and Information Systems. Height-1200-1700mm

Part. 08

Poster

A wayfinding & communication design system for the HCD Department, 4th Floor, R&D Building

रास्ता REDEFINED

DPP | HCD | IIIT DELHI

Group: Lakshika · Kinshuk
Prashant · Inaya

01 RESEARCH METHODS

Understanding the space, the people and the existing communication

OBSERVE — Unguided walk-through from the lift as a first-time visitor.

DOCUMENT — We have documented and have sever photos and videos of the floor

ANALYSE — Checked visibility, placement, hierarchy & consistency of every sign.

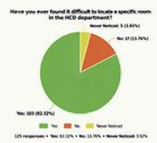
STUDY — Analyze the problems and iterate the solutions.

ITERATE

FIELD NOTES



SURVEY DATA



INTERVIEWS



02 ANALYSIS & INSIGHTS

Grouping what we interviewed into themes

AFFINITY MAP



EMPATHY MAP



EMPATHY MAP



03 DIVERGENT PROBLEM STATEMENT

KEY INSIGHT

- Users cannot easily understand where they are or which direction to take when entering the floor.
- Users depend on seniors, friends, landmarks, or trial-and-error because directional cues are limited.
- Users struggle to distinguish labs, faculty rooms, meeting rooms, and study spaces because they look visually similar.

FINAL PROBLEM STATEMENT

The HCD floor lacks a consistent visual communication system that helps users orient, navigate, identify spaces, and understand information independently.

04 IDEATING & EXPLORATION

Diverging on formats, converging on a system

IDEAS EXPLORED



ITERATIONS



1. Wall map
Read only up close

2. Angled lectern
Readable at a glance

3. Wing colours
Left / right answered

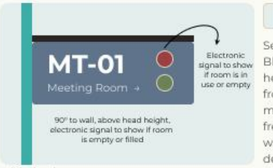
4. Blades & plates
Final system

05 FINAL DESIGN

A three-part wayfinding system for the HCD 4th floor



Lift-lobby directory, angled 30°



Blade sign



Modular door plate

DESIGN RATIONALE

Seen from the corridor, not just the door. Blade signs sit at 90° to the wall, above head height, so you read them end-on from down the hall. An LED on each meeting room blade shows if the room is free or in use, so you know before you walk all the way there. Wing colours decide direction: brown is A, slate blue is B, and they carry down every corridor.

DESIGN SYSTEM

COLOUR

A wing · B wing · InProcess · Empty · HCD

TYPE

Montserrat

Readable
Clear hierarchy
One consistent family

Thank you

धन्यवाद